



“PostgreSQL updates are solely driven by its community members”

The world of databases is taking on a new shape with the growth of Big Data. But how can an open source solution deliver a competitive edge against proprietary offerings?

Bruce Momjian, co-founder of **PostgreSQL Global Development Group** and **senior database architect** at **EnterpriseDB**, reveals this secret in an exclusive conversation with **Rahul Chopra** and **Jagmeet Singh** of **OSFY**.
Edited excerpts...

Q How has PostgreSQL evolved over the years?

Postgres has evolved from an academic project focused on bug fixing to an enterprise project the first added SQL standards then emphasized adding enterprise-class features. It is currently in the innovation stage where we are adding features no other database has. Now begins the Golden Age of Postgres when people use it because it does things no other database can.

Q Who drives the rollout process at Postgres? Is it solely driven by the community, or is there any role played by the EnterpriseDB team?

The rollout of PostgreSQL updates are solely driven by community members. However, inputs are taken from any user or organisation who wants to provide suggestions and feedback. EnterpriseDB supports the rollout of PostgreSQL releases by hosting software downloads and providing time

for key employees to spend on community work during release cycles.

Q Which would be the closest open source competitor for Postgres?

I do not think there is a competitor for Postgres. Several people leave MySQL because they prefer Postgres, but very few go the other way. The only real advantage MySQL has over Postgres is its install base and ISV applications. However, MySQL is not developed by an open source community. It is an open source option developed by Oracle..

Q What do you think are the key features of Postgres that keep it a step ahead of MySQL?

By any measure—features, performance, usability and reliability—Postgres is ahead of MySQL and has been for years. I think the only advantage MySQL has is its existing